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COVER LETTER

Product Designer, Connect | Chess.com

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Hi Chess.com team,

I am applying for the Product Designer role on Connect. I design social and game products, and I ship the front-end code, so I can take something from a problem statement to a working prototype without a handoff sitting in the middle.

The closest match to what Connect owns is Duggup, where I was the founding and only product designer for two years. It was a community platform for engineers across web and mobile, and I designed the home feed, customisable profiles, the question ranking that decided what each person saw first, and the engagement layer around it, including streaks, time-bound challenges, leaderboards and an activity ticker. We shipped version 1.0 in five months and had **2,000+ sign-ups in the first week**.

Before that I spent a year on Draftsy, a real-time fantasy sports app for US college sports. The work was live drafts with timed turns and auto-pick fallbacks, in-app chat, league creation and joining, and notification settings. We tracked where players abandoned the draft rather than only the drafts that finished, because in a social product the interesting behaviour belongs to the person who does not come back.

On craft and systems, my most recent work was N1 Care, an AI platform where I was the sole designer on a team of 23. I designed 10 product areas and built an **80+ component design system** on shared tokens, then worked with engineering to implement it in code using Claude Code and the Figma MCP.

Prototyping with Claude and Cursor is already how I work rather than something I would be picking up for this role. Over the last year I designed and built a live 2v2 ranking app with its own rating engine on web, iOS and Android, and a real-time multiplayer word game. Both are linked on my resume and you can open them right now.

One last thing worth saying plainly. I have been on Chess.com as DicKay15 since May 2020, somewhere around 800 rapid and playing in bursts. That makes this the first role I have applied to where I already use the product for fun, and it also makes me the exact player your team is trying to bring back.

Thank you for reading,

Dhrumil Kherde